

Website Editing Guide

How to update the [Institution] website

For content editors

August 2026

Welcome

This site is designed so you can update it yourself, with no code and no HTML. You edit through a friendly web page called the **content editor**, click **Save**, and your change is live in about 30 seconds.

You do **not** need to install anything. You only need:

- A **GitHub account** that has been given access to the site (your administrator sets this up once).
- The editor address: `https://<your-site>/admin/`

If you can use a word processor and fill in a web form, you can edit this site.

What you can change (and what you can't)

This is deliberate. It keeps you in control of content while protecting the design so nothing can accidentally break.

You can edit:

- The text on any page
- Images on a page (upload/replace)
- Footer and contact information
- The donate box wording
- The site's colour theme (from a set of pre-approved options)
- Embedded videos

Your administrator handles (by design): the page layout, fonts, navigation menu, and the donation integration. If you need one of those changed, just ask them.

Signing in

1. Go to `https://<your-site>/admin/`
2. Click “**Sign in with GitHub.**”
3. Approve the access request (first time only).

You’re now in the editor. On the left you’ll see the sections you can edit: **Pages**, **Sections**, and **Site Settings**.

Editing a page

1. Click **Pages** (or **Sections**) in the left sidebar.
2. Click the page you want to edit (e.g. *About & History*).
3. Edit the fields:
 - **Title:** the page heading.
 - **Description:** a one-line summary (used for search engines).
 - **Body:** the main content. Use the toolbar for **bold**, *italic*, links, lists, and headings. You can switch between the rich-text view and plain Markdown with the toggle.
4. Click **Save** (top right).

Your change publishes automatically and is live in ~30 seconds.

Adding or replacing an image

1. In a page’s body, click where you want the image and choose the **image** button in the toolbar. Or, for a dedicated image field (like the About portrait), click the image field.
2. **Upload** a new image, or pick one already in the media library.
3. Save.

Tips

- Use reasonably sized images (aim for under ~500 KB) so pages stay fast.
 - Add a **caption/attribution** if the photo requires credit (e.g. a Creative-Commons or archive photo).
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Site Settings (footer, contact, donate)

1. Click **Site Settings** ▢ **Global** in the sidebar.
2. Update any of:
 - **Organization name**
 - **Footer / contact:** email, mailing address, meeting/jam info
 - **Donate widget:** button label, headline, blurb
3. Save. These appear site-wide.

Changing the colour theme

1. Go to **Site Settings** ▢ **Global** ▢ **Theme**.
2. Choose a **Color preset** from the dropdown:
 - **Clay & Cream** (warm, default)
 - **Ink & Paper** (editorial)
 - **Forest** (deep green)
 - **Slate** (cool blue)
3. Save. The whole site re-themes.

The presets are pre-designed and contrast-checked, so any choice will look good and stay readable.

Embedding a video

1. Edit the page (usually in Markdown view for this).
2. Add a line like:

```
{{< videoembed id="YOUTUBE_ID" title="Video title" caption="Optional caption." >}}
```

The **YouTube ID** is the part after `watch?v=` in the video's URL (e.g. in `youtube.com/watch?v=U1RmAkwH4BY`, the ID is `U1RmAkwH4BY`).

3. Save.

If you're not comfortable with this, send your administrator the video link and they'll add it.

Publishing & undo

- **Publishing:** every **Save** publishes automatically (~30 seconds to go live).
 - **Undo:** every change is versioned. If something goes wrong, your administrator can restore any previous version instantly. Nothing is ever truly lost.
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Do's and don'ts

Do

- Preview your wording before saving.
- Keep images optimised and captioned where needed.
- Ask your administrator for anything structural (menu, layout, new page types).

Don't

- Don't paste large blocks of formatted text from Word directly. Use the editor's formatting instead (cleaner results).
 - Don't worry about "breaking the site." You only have access to safe content fields, and everything is recoverable.
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Getting help

For anything outside the fields above (a new page type, a layout change, a navigation update, or a login that stops working), contact your **administrator**.